

Expected Linear Time Algorithm for Computing 3D Relative Neighborhood Graphs

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ABSTRACT

An expected linear time algorithm ($O(n)$) for computing the relative neighborhood graph (RNG) for points in Euclidean space, distributed uniformly in a unit three dimensional cube is given. To the author's knowledge, this improves on the previously best known $O(n \log(n))$ in three dimensions. The algorithm considers an individual anchor point and limits a volume that potential RNG neighbors can be in through a plane partition heuristic. The K surrounding potential neighbors are then tested with a naive $O(K^3)$ algorithm. The RNG has finite degree when considering random point distributions in three dimensions, resulting in an expected finite K , making $O(K^3) = O(1)$, providing the linear expected time algorithm when enumerating through all points.

1. Introduction

Let $P = (p_0, p_1, \dots, p_{n-1})$ be a set of points in $\mathbb{R}^3$. The relative neighborhood graph, $\text{RNG}(P)$, is a graph that connects two vertices, p_i, p_j if and only if there is no other vertex within the *lune* between them.

$$(p_i, p_j) \in \text{RNG}(P) \\ \iff |p_i - p_j| \leq \max_{k \neq i, j} (|p_i - p_k|, |p_j - p_k|)$$

Figure ?? shows a graphical representation of points connected

2. Related Work

3. Motivation and Structure

For $P = (p_0, p_1, \dots, p_{n-1})$, a brief overview of the algorithm roughly proceeds as follows:

- Create a grid, where each cell size of $\frac{1}{n^{1/3}}$
- Bin points into grid cells, allowing for multiple points in a bin
- For each point, p (called an *anchor point*):
 - keep adding neighbor points, q , from nearby grid cells and discard further away points whose connection to p would be sabotaged by the existence of q
 - keep extending the radius of grid cells and collecting potential q neighbors until all other points outside the currently considered grid cells are guaranteed to not be able to connect to p
 - add nearby additional points as needed and run a naive relative neighborhood graph calculation for p on the pool of q neighbors collected

A coarse grained plane partition heuristic is used to exclude further away points from consideration.

Given points p and q , any point, w , that lies on the other side of the plane with normal $\frac{(q-p)}{|q-p|}$ that passes through q , cannot connect to p , as q would be in any lune that p and w would create. Figure ?? gives a graphical representation of points excluded by this plane heuristic in two dimensions.

The plane partition heuristic is coarse, as the entire region that q excludes from p is more complicated (see Figure ??). While the plane partition heuristic is coarse, it's easy to calculate and provides a good enough way to exclude large portions of points so that it can be used as the foundation for an expected linear time algorithm.

To maintain a linear time algorithm, we need to avoid processing points individually and to implicitly exclude large collection of points that can never connect to the our anchor point p . To do this, we consider a current grid cell collection of integral radius $R \in \mathbb{Z}$, centered on the grid cell where anchor point p resides. If the tangent planes that passes through neighbor q , and in direction $(q - p)$ within the grid cell collection, partition each of the six sides of our cube of radius R , we can be assured that any points outside of the grid cell collection will never be able to connect to p .

A grid cell collection of a radius R is called a *fence* of radius $R \in \mathbb{Z}$. When R is understood from context, this will be called just a *fence*. If the sides of the *fence* has been partitioned, with anchor point p and neighbors q within the *fence*, the *fence* will be called *secured*.

Points outside of the *fence* will never be able to connect to anchor point p but they still might be in the lune of some points within the *fence*. For this reason, when collecting points for the naive relative neighborhood graph calculation, some points outside of the fence will need to be added, as they can sabotage potential edges within the *fence*.

This will be done by considering a larger radius of the current *fence* to add points but the increase in R will shown to be bounded by a constant factor, allowing overall linear time to be maintained.

Before discussing the algorithm in detail, preliminary structural results will be discussed.

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If w is on the other side of the plane that passes through q and with tangent in the direction of $(q - p)$, then q will always be in the lune created by p and w (see Figure ??):

Lemma 1 (Plane Partition Heuristic).

$$p, q, w \in \mathbb{R}^3$$

if

$$w \in H_{p,q}^+ = \{u : (q - p) \cdot (u - q) \geq 0\}$$

then

$$q \in L_{p,w} = \{v : |v - p| \leq |p - w| \text{ \& } |v - w| \leq |p - w|\}$$

.

Only points within the convex hull need to be considered for a relative neighborhood graph connection to p :

Theorem 2. Let $p \in \mathbb{R}^3$, $Q = (q_0, q_1, \dots, q_{m-1}) \subset P$ and C be the compact convex hull created from $H_i^- = \{u \in \mathbb{R}^3 | (q_i - p) \cdot (u - q_i) < 0\}$, then $w \notin C \rightarrow w \notin \text{RNG}(P, p)$

PROOF. All w outside of C will have some $q_i \in Q$ in the $L(w, p)$ lune, so cannot have an RNG edge to p .

4. Algorithm

5. Conclusion

6. Bibliography

A. Appendix.0

For completeness, this section discusses the elementary but tedious calculations for the plume shape and volume. As a reminder, our goal is to show that increasing the grid fence by a fixed size will almost surely encapsulate a compact convex hull made from an anchor point and its neighbors. The convex hull guarantees that the relative neighborhood graph edges of the anchor point to its neighbors need only consider candidate points within the convex hull (with some caveats about extending the grid fence to include saboteurs, detailed in section ??).

The logic chain is roughly:

- For an anchor point, p , and a grid fence side, there will be a region that a neighbor point can fall in that will partition the fence side from the point, a process we call *securing the fence*, where a secured fence necessarily implies a compact convex hull made from the points on the interior
- The volume that secures a fence side will turn out to be four sphere slices joined together, which we will call a *plume*, where a sphere slice is the intersection of two perpendicular half planes and a sphere
- A lower bound on the plume volume is a constant proportion of overall grid fence volume

- A non-trivial finite plume volume makes the question of how many neighbors to be expected to secure the overall six sided fence into a coupon collector-like problem, giving us an expected finite grid fence size
- Finally, coarse estimates of the slice given by two tetrahedrons stacked end-to-end, fully enclosed in the slice, will give a concrete approximation on the four slices bundled together and allow us to give coarse concrete values for grid fence sizes

It should be stressed that the discussion and estimates are meant primarily to show existence of a finite grid fence size. We focus on securing a fence side by waiting for some single neighbor point to secure it, which is equivalent to considering a four post fence side. The Shrinking Posts on Increasing Fence (SPoIF) algorithm in this paper has a smaller expected grid fence size as points can secure parts of the fence through clusters of posts, increasing the admissible region of points that are able to secure fence faces.

The calculations done in this appendix are meant to show that we only need to consider a finite grid fence size by providing correct, if horrible, bounds. In this paper, we are satisfied with providing empherical results for grid sizes that SPoIF uses without going into more rigorous analysis.

First consider a fixed point q and a fixed but moveable point η .

We think of η as a point on a plane with normal $\eta/|\eta|$ that intersects q in the slice of $z = 0$ to $z = 1$.

As we vary η we want to know what the shape is traced out.

The claim is that this is the surface of a sphere whose center is at $q/2$ of radius $q/2$.

To see this, consider $\eta = q/2 + (|q|/2)v$, with $|v| = 1$.

Calculate dot product of the line from q to η with the line from the origin to η :

$$\begin{aligned} \eta &= q/2 + (|q|/2)v \\ (q/2 + (|q|/2)v) \cdot (q/2 + (|q|/2)v - q) \\ &= (q/2 + (|q|/2)v) \cdot (-q/2 + (|q|/2)v) \\ &= -(1/4)|q|^2 + (|q|/2)^2|v|^2 \\ &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

Proving the claim.

We want to find the the minimum volume of the plume for some point inside of a fence of radius s (side length $2s$) nested inside of a larger fence of radius $s(2k+1)$ (side length $2s(2k+1)$).

First consider a sphere of radius R centered at $(-D, -D, -D)$ intersected with two half planes, $H_{x=0}^+ = \{u : u_x \geq 0\}$, $H_{y=0}^+ = \{u : u_y \geq 0\}$. For suitable R and D , we want to estimate the volume.

If we take two tetrahedrons completely enclosed by the slice, the maximum diagonal of the slice is $(R - \sqrt{2}D)$, with maximum straight side length (in the x -axis line and y -axis line) to also be $(R - \sqrt{2}D)$ and slice half height to also be $(R - \sqrt{2}D)$.

The volume of the tetrahedron is then:

$$(1/6)(R - \sqrt{2}D)^2 \sqrt{R^2 - 2D^2}$$

The volume of the two tetrahedrons stacked on top of each other:

$$(1/3)(R - \sqrt{2}D)^2 \sqrt{R^2 - 2D^2}$$

More succinctly:

$$V_{\text{slice}} > \frac{1}{3}(R - \sqrt{2}D)^2 \sqrt{R^2 - 2D^2}$$

We will get concrete estimates below but as a quick confirmation, we can check to make sure that this slice is a constant proportion of the fence it sits in.

We know that $R \propto (ks)$ and $D \propto (ks)$, for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$ and grid cell size $s \in \mathbb{R}$. Call $R = \alpha(ks)$ and $D = \beta(ks)$.

The plume will be four slices bundled together sitting inside of a $\gamma^3(ks)^3$ volume. Take $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R}$ to be the smallest of the four slices:

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{(4/3)(\alpha(ks) - \sqrt{2}\beta(ks))^2 \sqrt{\alpha^2(ks)^2 - 2\beta^2(ks)^2}}{\gamma^3(ks)^3} \\ &= \frac{(4/3)(ks)^3 (\alpha - \sqrt{2}\beta)^2 \sqrt{\alpha^2 - 2\beta^2}}{\gamma^3(ks)^3} \\ &= \frac{(4/3)(\alpha - \sqrt{2}\beta)^2 \sqrt{\alpha^2 - 2\beta^2}}{\gamma^3} \end{aligned}$$

as desired.

When choosing random points inside of the larger fence cube, we can think of the plume as the probability a single point secures one side of the fence. It is equivalent to talk about securing one side of the fence face with securing four posts on each of corners of the fence face. As a reminder, the Shrinking Posts on Increasing Fence (SPoIF) uses nine posts per face, equally distributed along the face square. Since there are more opportunities to secure clusters of posts on a fence face, in addition to still retaining the features of the plume region, SPoIF will be able to secure the fence cube more quickly. We only consider the four post fence here to help simplify the calculation even though it inflates the expected number of points we need to see to secure the grid fence.

Take the minimum plume value volume of the six directions and call it V_{plume} . The probability that a point lands in one of the plumes is bounded below by $V_{\text{plume}}/V_{\text{fence}}$. Of the points that land in one of the plumes, the time we need to take to secure each face of the fence is now a coupon collector-like problem with six coupons.

We can now plug in some real numbers to get coarse bounds on plume volumes, probabilities of landing in the critical region and expected grid sizes.

As a reminder, we are considering a center grid cell, of side length s where the anchor point, p , resides, all of which is inside a larger grid fence of side length $2s(k+1)$, for some fixed $k \geq 0, k \in \mathbb{Z}$ as yet to be determined.

The smallest size a slice can be is if the anchor point is on the corner of the interior grid cell and to choose the grid

fence corner nearest to it. For example, $p = (s/2, s/2, s/2)$, $q = (s(k+1)/2, s(k+1)/2, s(k+1)/2)$.

In such a case, the center point of the sphere is $(p+q)/2 = (s(k+1)/2, s(k+1)/2, s(k+1)/2)$, with radii $R = |(p+q)/2 - p| = |(sk/2, sk/2, sk/2)| = (\sqrt{3}/2)sk$. Here, $D = s(k+1)/2 - s/2 = sk/2$ with $V_{\text{fence}} = (s(2k+1))^3$.

This yields:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{V_{\text{plume}}}{V_{\text{fence}}} &> \frac{\frac{4}{3}(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}sk - \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}sk)^2 (\frac{3}{4}s^2k^2 - \frac{1}{2}s^2k^2)^{\frac{1}{2}}}{s^3(2k+1)^3} \\ &= \frac{s^3k^3(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2})^2}{3\sqrt{2}s^3(2k+1)^3} \\ &= \frac{(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2})^2}{3\sqrt{2}(2+\frac{1}{k})^3} \\ &> \frac{(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2})^2}{81\sqrt{2}} \quad (k \geq 1) \\ &> 1/1198 \end{aligned}$$

For points that land within one of the six plume region, we would expect this to be a six coupon collector problem with, at worst, equal probability. The coupon collector problem grows roughly as $n \log(n)$ which, in our case of six sides of the fence to secure, gives us an expected 11 or more points before we secure the fence.

Each point has roughly a $6/1198$ chance of landing in one of the six plumes, so we would expect roughly $11/(6/1198) = 2196.3 \dots$ number of points within the grid fence to appear before securing the fence.

Each grid cell has roughly one point, so we would expect the number grid cells on a side to be

$$\begin{aligned} & (11 \cdot 1198/6)^{\frac{1}{3}} \\ &= 12.9 \dots \sim 13 \end{aligned}$$

That is, we would expect $k \sim 6$, iterating roughly six to seven steps of increasing the grid fence size until securing the fence in this way.

B. Appendix.1

... Appendix sections are coded under \appendix.

References

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